Paul Bristow-Bovey

UX / UI / INTERACTION AND MOTION DESIGNER

Hi, I'm Paul - a senior UX designer with over a decade of experience designing, and delivering digital products across agency, consultancy, and development house environments.

My career began in visual and interactive design, and evolved to focus on usability, systems thinking, and product value, particularly within complex and regulated domains.

In previous roles, I have led UX and UI strategy for large-scale digital platforms, created and maintained design systems, and worked closely with front-end and back-end developers and executive stakeholders ensuring design intent translates into quality execution.

My experience spans SaaS platforms, financial services apps and platforms, e-learning content creation, and mobile products, with a consistent emphasis on clarity, scalability, and user-centred outcomes.

Currently, I am freelancing and expanding my practice to include motion as a communication and comprehension tool, and exploring emerging UX developments in AI-assisted workflows.

I'm now seeking a senior UX role within a product-led organisation where I can contribute strategic thinking, system design expertise, and collaborative leadership. I'm looking for the opportunity to contribute to a platform that brings clarity and alignment to complex decisions - and to partner with a team that values thoughtful design, user empowerment, and business impact, as I do.

Thanks for your time.

Paul Bristow-Bovey

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Experience:

Freelancer / contractor
UX, UI, motion design

April 2023 — Present
Cape Town

Currently freelancing as a motion designer, producing e-learning content for Laragh Courseware. This entails:

- Translate technically authored scripts and AI-generated voiceovers into clear, engaging short-form explainer videos.
- Design for, and maintain a shared, Figma-based asset library used across a motion design team - ensuring consistency and production efficiency.
- Storyboard visual concepts, and iterate if need be, prior to animation.
- Produce 2D explainer videos in After Effects, using motion, and sicched to a VO to communicate various concepts clearly and effectively.

I am actively looking into UX for XR and what the future possibilities and challenges lie ahead for users (Current Udemy course: Transitioning to XR UX Design).

Presently i am learning about Figma MCP integrated with an IDE, running an AI agent to generate production-ready React components from Figma frames.

Catch & Release - Agency
Lead UX designer

February 2022 – April 2023
Cape Town

- Catch & Release operates as rain's in-house digital agency. I Led UX and UI design in the agency on the rain website, Android app, animated CSS banners.
- Mentored UX and UI designers, ensuring high-quality output aligned with stakeholder and business goals.
- Acted as the bridge between the agency and rain's front-end and back-end development teams, ensuring accurate execution.
- Created a comprehensive, component-based design system in Figma, standardising digital output and improving iteration and delivery efficiency.
- Introduced Lottie SVG animations to enable lightweight, resolution-independent, cross-platform motion, replacing the antiquated animated Gif's.
- Optimised key user journeys, promotions, and product offerings in close collaboration with rain's development team and executive stakeholders.

Full Stack - Dev house
Head of UX

February 2015 — December 2020
Cape Town

I led and mentored a young team of digital designers and front-end developers working on a wide of range digital products for brands from the financial services sector, amongst others. Some of these include:

Sanlam: *(Insurance & Investment Management)*

- **Sanlam go cover app -** UX and UI design process, HTML email creation and UX and technical testing across all email clients, and browser types and versions.
- **Sanlams Concept Bluestar -** Stakeholder interviews, wireframing and prototyping, front-end development and testing.
- **Sanlams Glacier -** Stakeholder interviews, wireframing and prototyping, front-end development and testing.

PSG: *(Asset & Wealth Management)*

- **Website -** Persona development, wireframing front-end development.

ASISA: *(Investment Capital)*

- **Website -** Analysis, stakeholder interviews, wireframing, prototyping, design, front-end development, testing and iterating.

Publicis Machine - agency
Head of UX

October 2013 – Jan 2015
Cape Town

- Owned UX and UI delivery across multiple brands, from discovery to execution.
- Led persona development, stakeholder and user interviews, wireframes, clickable low and high fidelity prototypes, and front-end implementation.
- Mentored front-end developers and collaborated closely with studio teams to translate creative concepts into usable and viable digital assets.
- Embedded within an Agile delivery lifecycle, working alongside product owners and project managers to drive continuous improvement.
- Notable Brands: Sanlam, Red Bull, Appletiser, Weet-Bix, SASKO

Freelance / consultant
Designer

April 2013 – September 2013
Cape Town

- Consultant UX designer for Protea Hotels, conducting heuristic evaluations and analytics reviews.
- Identified friction points in the booking journey and collaborated with teams to streamline conversion.
- Designed and implemented modular HTML email templates adaptable across multiple hotel locations and email clients.

Global Vision
Lead Designer

April 2011 – February 2013
Cape Town

- Led design and front-end development across intranets, websites, and business applications. Designed marketing materials for a range brands and products.
- Collaborated on early SaaS CRM platform development, gaining foundational exposure to formal UX methodologies, and mentored by a UX leader of the time.
- This period marked a pivotal shift from visual design toward usability-driven, product-focused UX thinking.

Laragh Courseware
Graphic Designer

January 2005 – March 2011
Cape Town

Laragh Courseware is an E-Learning company, that creates interactive learning materials. I created guided software simulations, in Macromedia Director and Adobe Flash. Creating these simulations peaked my interest in UX. as I came to notice making these simulations that software often wasn't intuitive by nature. This was when I first started to think about how users interact, learn and delight in software they use. "It just works..., and just easy to use..." is what software development, should invoke in their users. I believe this was when it dawned on me that design without purpose served as just aesthetic decoration.

Page Arts
Graphic Designer - Desk Top Publishing

January 2001 – March 2005
Cape Town

Page Arts (DTP) business that did print layouts for institutions like UCT's lecture materials, the Western Cape Government Statute books, as well as layouts for independent authors. I was responsible for image retouching, deep-etching and prepping files for print, and some page layouts.

Yes *Xpress*
Graphic Designer

January 1998 – January 2001
Cape Town, Cavendish and Blue Route Tokai, branches

I worked in the document services department. Specialising in high-quality signage, photocopies, and brochure print design. This was my first real job as a designer.

McCann Erickson - agency
Intern

February 1996 – July 1997
Cape Town

After finishing my graphic design training at Hirt & Carter, I was fortunate enough to secure an internship at Mccann agency. Here, my newly acquired skills in Photoshop, and Freehand were put to use in a live production environment for the first time. I worked primarily on the Pick n Pay account, deep-etching and retouching product shots for print layouts.

Education:

UX South Africa

2014-2015-2016
Cape Town

A yearly conference that delved into the latest UX trends, how they are being adapted and what experts in the community are doing to improve on user centred design.

Flow UX design best practices course

February 2012
Cape Town

A course run by Phil Barrett from Flow, on UX design best practices covering the following topics:

- **Affinity diagrams**
- **Point of view statements**
- **User scenarios**
- **User interviews**
- **Customer journey maps**
- **Storyboarding**
- **User personas**
- **Heuristic evaluations**

Concept Interactive

February 2002
Cape Town

My first introduction to OOP programming, animation, sound integration, ActionScript 3, Lingo script. The 4 month course covered Adobe Flash and Director. This was my first experience into the world of interaction design, scripting and animation.

Mac KnowHow

February 1999
Cape Town

An advanced Photoshop course covering the following:

- **Re-touching techniques**
- **Colour correction**
- **Essential principles for good design**

Hirt & Carter

1995
Cape Town

Comprehensive DTP, and graphic design diploma. This was my introduction to digital. We covered Photoshop, Freehand and Quark Express.

Cape Town High School

1994
Cape Town

Matriculated with exemption.

Thanks for reading.